



1. A freshly restored 1947 Buick Roadmaster Model 76-C owned by Maharaja Gaj Singh of Jodhpur

2. Jaguar XK120 Roadster, a valuable piece of India's motorsport heritage

3. Yohan Poonawalla's 1928 Rolls-Royce Phantom 1 designed by Henry Royce himself. The car, first bought by the Maharaja of Kashmir, left Indian shores in early 1970s, before Poonawalla got it back for his collection

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Bengal, says getting parts is the biggest challenge. Roy restored a Mercedes-Benz 170 V Roadster from 1938 after buying it as scrap. "It was only the chassis with half a door and half a fender. From there, we built it in our workshop. We went to Stuttgart to get parts from Mercedes. But they had nothing for us," says Roy, who also restored the iconic 1937 German Wanderer which was used by Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose to escape house arrest during the British Raj in 1941.

Getting parts for American cars has also become difficult, says Allan Almeida, a restorer who worked on Maharaja of Jodhpur's dual-tone 1947 Buick. "The only challenge was getting parts. For American cars, parts were easy to get. But post Covid, it has become difficult. Anything that's hard to get, we ebay," he says.

Rolls-Royce's Nikkein says lack of spares is not easy to tackle. "They work better with third-party suppliers. Engineering behind vintage cars is different from modern cars," she says.

This year's show put the spotlight on cars coach built in India from 1910 to 1945 and India's motorsport heritage. In Pre-War American Classics, the competing cars ranged from the rare 1905 Oldsmobile to the 1936 Dodge, a convertible sedan owned by the Benares royal family. Pre-War European Classics on display included Lagonda Weymann Saloon, Alvis Sports Tourer, and Bentley Drop-head Coupe among others. Other famous marques included Bugatti, Delaunay-Belleville, Alfa Romeo, Cadillac, and Sunbeam.

Vintage car collectors have restored these cars to precise

standards and specifications as they came out of the factory, Arjun Oberoi, executive chairman of EIH, the holding company of Oberoi Hotels, tells *BT*. "We are seeing a renewed interest from Indian collectors. Some of the cars have been in the same family for generations. Maybe they skipped a generation where their parents or grandparents didn't really appreciate what they had. So, the younger generation suddenly said wow, this is something unique. Let's restore it."

For collectors and enthusiasts alike, events like the Oberoi Concours d'Elegance are not merely exhibitions of wealth or nostalgia, but celebrations of craftsmanship and motoring heritage that continue to captivate generations. **BT**

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